

Mumbai woman duped of ₹1.3 cr in year-long dating app scam involving fake govt officials

A 65-year-old homemaker was scammed out of Rs 1.3 crore after being deceived through a dating app. The criminals behind the scam used emotional manipulation, fake identities, and impersonation of officials to carry out their fraud over the course of more than a year. The incident began in April 2023 when the woman connected with a man on the dating app International Cupid. The scammer, who introduced himself as Paul Rutherford, claimed to be an American civil engineer working in the Philippines, reports TOI. <https://tinyurl.com/5xhk8sbk>

Government orders 6 lakh phones to be deactivated, 800 apps blocked

Recognising the urgency to combat this growing threat, the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has launched a series of robust measures to tackle cybercrime. The I4C wing, dedicated to cyber security, is at the forefront of this initiative, taking significant steps to protect citizens from online scams. In a bold move, the government has deactivated 6,00,000 mobile phones. Alongside this, the I4C has successfully blocked 65,000 URLs associated with scams, effectively cutting off pathways for cyber fraudsters. <https://tinyurl.com/thjytxrc>

Mumbai-based IT professional loses ₹1.16 cr after clicking on fake advertisement

A recent case from Vasai, Mumbai, highlights just how vulnerable we all are to online scams. A 49-year-old IT professional, a senior executive at a well-known company, lost Rs 1.16 crore after clicking on a fake online ad that promised high returns from stock market investments. The scam began when the victim came across an advertisement online offering huge profits from stock market investments. Curious, he clicked on the ad and was directed to a WhatsApp group with around 125 members. <https://tinyurl.com/4xafkfvf>

Woman loses ₹23.5 lakh in work-from-home scam

Scammers often use the promise of easy money to trick people into parting with their hard-earned savings. This unfortunate reality hit a woman who recently lost Rs 23.5 lakh to a work-from-home scam. On September 21, she received a WhatsApp message from an unknown sender offering her an opportunity to earn money by doing simple tasks from home. Although she initially declined the offer, the scammer convinced her to reconsider by offering a lucrative deal. The scam involved liking restaurants, places, and hotels online, leaving 5-star reviews, and commenting positively. In return, the woman was told she would earn money. Once she agreed, the scammer sent her a Telegram link and asked her to join a group. <https://tinyurl.com/38b85u4d>

Malaysian woman falls for ₹4.2 crore fraud in 7 year long online dating scam

A 67-year-old Malaysian woman fell victim to one of the most widespread and long-running online dating scam. The woman lost more than RM 2.2 million (approximately Rs 4.2 crore) over the course of seven years. It all started in October 2017, when a man posing as an American businessman living in Singapore initiated the relationship. Following that, within 7 years, the woman made over 300 bank transfers to the scammer in an attempt to assist him during the crisis. First met on Facebook, the scammer pretended to be a businessman working for the medical equipment industry. He later claimed that he intended to move to Malaysia but would be unable to afford the travel expenses. <https://tinyurl.com/5t3rbmxd>